公园里的早上

早上六点，公园里有什么？

Morning in the Park

What happens in the park at six in the morning?

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Footnotes mark names and words above HSK 2 (HSK 3.0 lists: github.com/ivankra/hsk30, MIT).

1 王小美[†]今年十四岁。放假了，她想天天睡觉。可是爸爸妈妈要上班，爷爷的腿不太好，一个人去公园，家里人不放心。妈妈说：“小美[‡]，明天早上六点，你跟爷爷去公园。”小美说：“六点？太早了！”

六点

2 第二天早上六点，爷爷来叫小美起床。小美不想起来，她说：“爷爷，太阳还没出来呢！”爷爷笑着说：“太阳正在起床呢。快，我们比太阳早一点儿！”小美很不高兴地穿衣服、洗脸。

3 路上很安静，没有车，也没有什么人。爷爷走得很慢，小美一边走，一边想：这么早，公园里一定也没有人。我在那儿做什么呢？一点儿也不好玩儿！

† 王小美 *Wáng Xiǎoměi* Wang Xiaomei, a schoolgirl

‡ 小美 *Xiǎoměi* Xiaomei

Wang Xiaomei is fourteen. The holidays had started, and she wanted to sleep every day. But her parents had to go to work, and Grandpa's legs weren't very good, so the family didn't like him going to the park on his own. Mum said, "Xiaomei, tomorrow at six in the morning, you're going to the park with Grandpa." "Six?" said Xiaomei. "That's far too early!" 1

Six O'Clock

At six the next morning, Grandpa came to wake Xiaomei up. Xiaomei didn't want to get up. "Grandpa," she said, "the sun isn't even up yet!" Grandpa laughed. "The sun is getting up right now. Hurry, let's beat it!" Very grumpily, Xiaomei got dressed and washed her face. 2

The street was quiet. There were no cars and hardly anyone about. Grandpa walked slowly, and as Xiaomei walked along beside him, she thought: It's so early, there won't be anyone in the park either. What am I going to do there? It'll be no fun at all! 3

公园里的人

4 可是，他们还没走到公园门口，小美[†]就听到了很多声音。进了公园，她看了看，啊，公园里的人这么多！有的人在唱歌，有的人在打球，有的人在走路，还有的人站在树下做运动。大家都很开心。

5 湖边，二十多个老人正在一起唱歌呢。他们唱得很大声，也很好听。不远的地方，几个老人带着自己的鸟。鸟在树上唱，人在树下听。他们一边听鸟唱歌，一边说话，笑得很开心。

6 爷爷在公园里也有很多朋友。他一到，就有人说："老王，你来了！今天谁跟你一起来的？"爷爷说："这是我家的小美。"小美以为公园里不好玩儿，可是现在她看看这儿，看看那儿，眼睛都不够用了。

† 小美 *Xiǎoměi* Xiaomei

The People in the Park

But before they even reached the park gate, Xiaomei could hear all sorts of sounds. Inside the park she looked around. Wow, there were so many people! Some people were singing, some were playing ball, some were walking, and others were exercising under the trees. Everyone was having a great time. 4

By the lake, more than twenty old people were singing together. They sang loudly, and it sounded lovely. Not far away, a few old men had brought their birds with them. The birds sang in the trees, and the people listened underneath. They chatted as they listened to the birds, laughing happily. 5

Grandpa had lots of friends in the park too. As soon as he arrived, someone called out, "Old Wang, you're here! Who's come with you today?" "This is our Xiaomei," said Grandpa. Xiaomei had thought the park would be boring, but now she was looking here and there, and her eyes couldn't take it all in. 6

7 爷爷和朋友们站在一起，跟着音乐做运动。他们的动作很慢，可是很认真。一个老奶奶对小美[†]说："你也来试试吧！"小美站在爷爷旁边，学着做。她以为老人的运动不会很累，可是做了十分钟，她就累了。爷爷笑着问："怎么样？比你想的难吧？"

地上的字

8 走到一个小广场，小美看见一个老人正在地上写字呢。他拿着很大的笔，用水在地上写。地上已经有很多字了，有的大，有的小，都很漂亮。可是过了一会儿，水干了，字也没有了。

9 小美小声问爷爷："字一会儿就没有了，他为什么还写？"老人听到了，笑着说："字没有了，可是我写字的时候很快乐啊。小朋友，你也来写一个吧！"

† 小美 *Xiǎoměi* Xiaomei

Grandpa and his friends stood together and exercised to music. Their move- 7
ments were slow, but they did them very carefully. An old lady said to Xiaomei, "You come and try too!" Xiaomei stood next to Grandpa and copied them. She thought the old people's exercises wouldn't be tiring, but after ten minutes she was tired. Grandpa laughed. "Well? Harder than you thought, isn't it?"

Characters on the Ground

When they came to a little square, Xiaomei saw an old man writing char- 8
acters on the ground. He held a huge brush and was writing on the ground with water. There were already lots of characters on the ground, some big and some small, and all of them beautiful. But after a while the water dried, and the characters were gone.

Xiaomei whispered to Grandpa, "The characters disappear in a moment. 9
Why does he still write them?" The old man heard her and smiled. "The characters go, but I'm happy while I'm writing them. Young lady, come and write one too!"

10 小美[†]拿着老人的笔，不知道写什么。她想了想，在地上写了一个大大的“早”字。字写得不太好看，可是老人说：“好！这个字好！早上的公园，最好了！”爷爷和他的朋友们都笑了。小美看着地上的“早”字一点儿一点儿没有了，可是她心里很高兴。

11 第二天早上，天还没有亮。爷爷正在睡觉呢，忽然听到有人叫他：“爷爷，快起床！六点了！我们去公园！”爷爷还以为自己听错了。可是小美已经穿好了衣服，笑着站在门口。爷爷看着她，也笑了：“好，我们走！”

† 小美 *Xiǎoměi* Xiaomei

Xiaomei held the old man's brush and didn't know what to write. She thought for a moment, then wrote a great big character on the ground: 早, "early". It wasn't very well written, but the old man said, "Good! That's a good character! The park in the morning is the best!" Grandpa and his friends all laughed. Xiaomei watched her 早 fade away bit by bit, but inside she felt very happy. 10

The next morning, it wasn't light yet. Grandpa was still asleep when he suddenly heard someone calling him: "Grandpa, get up! It's six o'clock! Let's go to the park!" Grandpa thought he must have heard wrong. But there was Xiaomei, already dressed, standing in the doorway with a smile. Grandpa looked at her and smiled too. "All right, let's go!" 11